Session 2: Register & Clarity Rewrite Studio

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Part A: One Message, Three Audiences

Core message: The review meeting has moved from Monday at 10 a.m. to Wednesday at 3 p.m., because our lead tester is unavailable on Monday.

Peer version

Quick update: the review meeting is now on Wednesday at 3, not Monday morning. Our lead tester can't make Monday and we need her there. Does Wednesday work for you?

Annotations

- Register: casual, with "quick update" and contractions.
- The times are shortened ("at 3") because a peer shares the context.
- A direct question at the end checks availability right away.
- The reason is stated in plain words, as a colleague would say it.

Manager version

The review meeting has been rescheduled from Monday at 10 a.m. to Wednesday at 3 p.m., as our lead tester is unavailable on Monday. The agenda is unchanged. Please confirm that the new slot suits your calendar.

Annotations

- Register: neutral and professional, using the passive "has been rescheduled" because the actor does not matter.
- Full times are given so nothing needs to be looked up.
- "The agenda is unchanged" answers the manager's likely next question.
- The closing line asks for confirmation, which is the action needed.

Client version

We would like to move our review meeting from Monday at 10 a.m. to Wednesday at 3 p.m., as a key member of our team is unavailable on Monday. We apologise for the change and hope the new time is convenient. If it is not, please suggest a time that suits you.

Annotations

- Register: formal and polite, built around "would like to" and "hope".
- "Lead tester" becomes "a key member of our team", which keeps internal roles private.
- It apologises once, then gives the client control by offering to adapt.
- Longer sentences and full forms signal respect for the client's time.

Part B: Three Ambiguous Sentences, Rewritten

Ambiguous sentence	Two possible meanings	Clear rewrite	Rule and why it works
I emailed the client about the invoice last week.	I emailed last week, or the invoice is from last week.	Last week, I emailed the client about the invoice.	A time phrase should sit next to what it describes. Moving it to the front attaches it to the verb.

Ambiguous sentence	Two possible meanings	Clear rewrite	Rule and why it works
She only asked the intern to test the login page.	She did nothing else but ask, she asked nobody else, or the intern was to test and not fix.	She asked only the intern to test the login page.	"Only" limits the word right after it, so I place it directly before the thing I want to limit.
Our team will not launch the app because of the deadline.	The deadline is the reason for not launching, or the team will launch, but not for the deadline.	Because of the deadline, our team will not launch the app.	A negative can reach over everything that follows. Putting the reason first keeps the negative on the action alone.